Other developments reported by the Indian Mission in Lhasa were also noteworthy. Small incidents of an adverse nature against Indian interests in Tibet began to surface. In April 1952, Chinese troops obstructed the movement of Indian diplomatic pouches, opened the ordinary mail bags, and searched the baggage of Indian military officers. Then, on 10 May 1952, the Trade Agent in Gyantse reported that Captain Chibber, the Commanding Officer of the Indian Military Escort in Gyantse, had been physically stopped by Chinese troops and forced to dismount his horse under threat of the gun, despite him and his party being in uniform. General Zhang Jingwu dismissed these as inconsequential incidents of a local nature. These untoward incidents appeared to be challenging India's special privileges under the treaties signed between Great Britain and Tibet, and should have triggered a review. Instead, the Government of India continued to wait for a response to their proposal for talks contained in the note that Panikkar had handed over in February. Consultation and coordination between the headquarters (New Delhi) and the field (Indian Mission in Lhasa) was poor in comparison with the way in which the Chinese central government and its representatives in Lhasa were working to achieve their goals.

The Chinese response finally came on 15 June 1952, by which time China was well entrenched in Tibet and the instructions that Zhou had given to Zhang Jingwu in Lhasa had been substantially carried out. Premier Zhou Enlai felt that the preparations now allowed him to open a discussion with Panikkar on Tibet. He began by making a general statement that all the treaties between Great Britain and Tibet were unequal treaties that were forced upon Tibet and China through aggression, and that the Chinese government deemed these treaties and agreements to be no longer in existence. He hoped that India had no intention of claiming 'special rights' arising